The men tasked with running the inquiries have not inspired confidence. Comptroller Yosef Shapira has been accused of stalling his investigations and softening their conclusions. The final report on household spending, for example, allegedly deleted an unfavorable comparison to expenses at the White House and Downing Street. Yehuda Weinstein, the attorney general from 2010 until January 2016, was Netanyahu's defense lawyer the first time the prime minister was investigated for corruption. His successor, Avichai Mandelblit, served previously as Netanyahu's cabinet secretary, and is thought to be a personal friend. Netanyahu appointed all three, along with the police chief, Roni Alsheich, who also seems to be shielding his boss. The terse official statement on the Sara Netanyahu probe did not mention that the police backed criminal charges, nor even her name—a break with usual policy. Those details were leaked later by frustrated investigators.

The scandal that felled Rabin was the revelation that his wife Leah had a foreign bank account, which was then illegal; she was later convicted and fined. It was a far less serious offense than anything Netanyahu is accused of, but he stepped down regardless. "We used to be a very homogeneous society, where nobody had a lot of money," said Ifat Zamir, the head of the Israeli branch of Transparency International. "And then in the 1990s, some people earned a lot of money, and the world changed with them. And so did the public's trust in the government."

"It's fun, I enjoy it"

It was, admittedly, a macabre subject: how to handle the bodies of Palestinian attackers. The interviewer was Razi Barkai, a veteran host on Army Radio; though it is run by the military, it often provides tough, balanced journalism. His interviewee, Gilad Erdan (the public security minister in Netanyahu's fourth government), said he did not believe they should be returned to families for burial. Barkai wondered whether their families were any different from the families of the two Israeli soldiers whose bodies have been held by Hamas since the end of the 2014 war in Gaza.

It was an emotionally charged comparison, but nonetheless a valid question about a deeply controversial topic. Moshe Ya'alon, who was then the defense minister, disagreed with Erdan's policy. But the director of Army Radio quickly apologized to listeners, and announced that Barkai's